

SHOWCASE

Super FlashCharge 120W

The Super FlashCharge 120W technology developed by Chinese phone manufacturer, Vivo, takes only five minutes to charge a 4000mAh phone battery to 50%. Prior to this, Huawei had showcased the Mate X's 55-watt fast charging which took just 30 minutes to charge a phone from 0 to 85% but this new tech from Vivo blows that out of the park. The Super FlashCharge can fully charge a 4000mAh phone from 0% to 100% in just 13 minutes. Vivo uses a 120W travel charger and a customised Type-C data cable for its fast charger.



Vivo's fast charger also trumps Xiaomi's new 100W charging technology, which claimed to be able to charge a 4000mAh battery in just 17 minutes. However, neither company's fast chargers are out in the market yet. There's also the

chance that the companies are trying to figure out the long term effects with such fast chargers. It's well known that fast charging can deteriorate the battery of a phone, significantly dropping their capacity. At these speeds, that deterioration will also probably be accelerated. We might not see this tech until a solution has been found, but we still can't wait to actually see our phones batteries zooming to full.

IBM e-tongue

After creating an artificial brain, IBM have now moved on to another body part, the tongue. They have created an AI assisted tongue called the e-tongue. This is a portable device which is equipped with sensors that allow it to "taste" and identify liquids. The advantage is that since it's not actually a human tongue, it can be used to distinguish liquids we wouldn't dare bring our tongues close to. The tongue is made up of a sensor array that uses pattern matching tech improved upon by



machine learning to figure out the composition of the liquid. Once it has gathered data on a liquid, it matches that data to different liquids already existing in its data set.

The e-tongue has been able to successfully distinguish between different brands of bottled water and replicate these results consistently. For now, IBM Research say the goal is to grow the database of liquids. This way, the e-tongue can be modified depending on use case.

There are a wide variety of possible uses for the e-tongue, from the culinary industry to the health industry. While it's great that it can help provide better healthcare, it's still weird thinking about using an e-tongue to sample urine.

Lightyear One

There should be no doubt in anyone's mind that electric is the way to go. Anything that doesn't make use of fossil fuels is a step in the right direction for us and the environment. Electric cars, however, still rely on the grid for power. And as we know, grids aren't always powered by clean sources.

This won't be an issue with the Lightyear One prototype. The Lightyear One is a car that collects the power it needs to run directly from the sun. The prototype is the creation of Lightyear, a startup based in the Netherlands, and was born under the name Stella. Lightyear One, then Stella, even won the Crunchie award in 2015, but has come a long way in the four years since. Lightyear One now looks pretty much road-ready.

The Lightyear One works by having the battery gather energy via the solar cells embedded in 16 sq feet of the car's safety glass on the roof. If it's not a particularly sunny day, don't worry, it can



be charged from regular outlets as well. Another thing that makes the Lightyear One standout is its range. The One boasts a range of a whopping 450 miles on a single charge. For a solar powered car that's a first. It also indicates that the car should hopefully be ready for the consumer market.

According to Lightyear, production for the One won't start until 2021, but that hasn't stopped people from buying it already. The startup claims that "over a hundred vehicles" have already been sold. Reservations for the electric solar-powered car do cost a whopping \$136,000 USD though.